40 Mat · Matthew

1 This is the record of the genealogy of Jesus Christ, the son of David, the son of Abraham:
[2] Abraham was the father of Isaac, Isaac the father of Jacob, and Jacob the father of Judah and his brothers.
[3] Judah was the father of Perez and Zerah by Tamar, Perez the father of Hezron, and Hezron the father of Ram.
[4] Ram was the father of Amminadab, Amminadab the father of Nahshon, and Nahshon the father of Salmon.
[5] Salmon was the father of Boaz by Rahab, Boaz the father of Obed by Ruth, Obed the father of Jesse,
[6] and Jesse the father of David the king. Next: David was the father of Solomon by Uriah's wife,
[7] Solomon the father of Rehoboam, Rehoboam the father of Abijah, and Abijah the father of Asa.
[8] Asa was the father of Jehoshaphat, Jehoshaphat the father of Joram, and Joram the father of Uzziah.
[9] Uzziah was the father of Jotham, Jotham the father of Ahaz, and Ahaz the father of Hezekiah.
[10] Hezekiah was the father of Manasseh, Manasseh the father of Amon, Amon the father of Josiah,
[11] and Josiah the father of Jeconiah and his brothers at the time of the exile to Babylon.
[12] After the exile to Babylon: Jeconiah was the father of Shealtiel, Shealtiel the father of Zerubbabel,
[13] Zerubbabel the father of Abiud, Abiud the father of Eliakim, and Eliakim the father of Azor.
[14] Azor was the father of Zadok, Zadok the father of Achim, and Achim the father of Eliud.
[15] Eliud was the father of Eleazar, Eleazar the father of Matthan, Matthan the father of Jacob,
[16] and Jacob the father of Joseph, the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ. [17] In all, then, there were fourteen generations from Abraham to David, fourteen from David to the exile to Babylon, and fourteen from the exile to the Christ.

[18] This is how the birth of Jesus Christ came about: His mother Mary was pledged in marriage to Joseph, but before they came together, she was found to be with child through the Holy Spirit. [19] Because Joseph her husband was a righteous man and was unwilling to disgrace her publicly, he resolved to divorce her quietly. [20] But after he had pondered these things, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream and said, "Joseph, son of David, do not be afraid to embrace Mary as your wife, for the One conceived in her is from the Holy Spirit." [21] "She will give birth to a Son, and you are to give Him the name Jesus, because He will save His people from their sins." [22] All this took place to fulfill what the Lord had said through the prophet: [23] "Behold, the virgin will be with child and will give birth to a son, and they will call Him Immanuel" (which means, "God with us"). [24] When Joseph woke up, he did as the angel of the Lord had commanded him, and embraced Mary as his wife. [25] But he had no union with her until she gave birth to a Son. And he gave Him the name Jesus.

2 After Jesus was born in Bethlehem in Judea, during the time of King Herod, Magi from the east arrived in Jerusalem, [2] asking, "Where is the One who has been born King of the Jews? We saw His star in the east and have come to worship Him." [3] When King Herod heard this, he was disturbed, and all Jerusalem with him. [4] And when he had assembled all the chief priests and scribes of the people, he asked them where the Christ was to be born. [5] "In Bethlehem in Judea," they replied, "for this is what the prophet has written:" [6] "'But you, Bethlehem, in the land of Judah, are by no means least among the rulers of Judah, for out of you will come a ruler who will be the shepherd of My people Israel.'"
[7] Then Herod called the Magi secretly and learned from them the exact time the star had appeared. [8] And sending them to Bethlehem, he said: "Go and search carefully for the Child, and when you find Him, report to me, so that I too may go and worship Him." [9] After they had heard the king, they went on their way, and the star they had seen in the east went ahead of them until it stood over the place where the Child was. [10] When they saw the star, they rejoiced with great delight. [11] On coming to the house, they saw the Child with His mother Mary, and they fell down and worshiped Him. Then they opened their treasures and presented Him with gifts of gold and frankincense and myrrh. [12] And having been warned in a dream not to return to Herod, they withdrew to their country by another route.

[13] When the Magi had gone, an angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream. "Get up!" he said. "Take the Child and His mother and flee to Egypt. Stay there until I tell you, for Herod is going to search for the Child to kill Him." [14] So he got up, took the Child and His mother by night, and withdrew to Egypt, [15] where he stayed until the death of Herod. This fulfilled what the Lord had spoken through the prophet: "Out of Egypt I called My Son." [16] When Herod saw that he had been outwitted by the Magi, he was filled with rage. Sending orders, he put to death all the boys in Bethlehem and its vicinity who were two years old and under, according to the time he had learned from the Magi.
[17] Then what was spoken through the prophet Jeremiah was fulfilled: [18] "A voice is heard in Ramah, weeping and great mourning, Rachel weeping for her children, and refusing to be comforted, because they are no more."
[19] After Herod died, an angel of the Lord appeared in a dream to Joseph in Egypt. [20] "Get up!" he said. "Take the Child and His mother and go to the land of Israel, for those seeking the Child's life are now dead." [21] So Joseph got up, took the Child and His mother, and went to the land of Israel. [22] But when he learned that Archelaus was reigning in Judea in place of his father Herod, he was afraid to go there. And having been warned in a dream, he withdrew to the district of Galilee, [23] and he went and lived in a town called Nazareth. So was fulfilled what was spoken through the prophets: "He will be called a Nazarene."

3 In those days John the Baptist came, preaching in the wilderness of Judea [2] and saying, "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is near." [3] This is he who was spoken of through the prophet Isaiah: "A voice of one calling in the wilderness, 'Prepare the way for the Lord, make straight paths for Him.'" [4] John wore a garment of camel's hair, with a leather belt around his waist. His food was locusts and wild honey. [5] People went out to him from Jerusalem and all Judea and the whole region around the Jordan. [6] Confessing their sins, they were baptized by him in the Jordan River. [7] But when John saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees coming to his place of baptism, he said to them, "You brood of vipers, who warned you to flee from the coming wrath?" [8] Produce fruit, then, in keeping with repentance. [9] And do not presume to say to yourselves, 'We have Abraham as our father.' For I tell you that out of these stones God can raise up children for Abraham. [10] The axe lies ready at the root of the trees, and every tree that does not produce good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire. [11] I baptize you with water for repentance, but after me will come One more powerful than I, whose sandals I am not worthy to carry. He will baptize you with the Holy Spirit and with fire. [12] "His winnowing fork is in His hand to clear His threshing floor and to gather His wheat into the barn; but He will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire."
[13] At that time Jesus came from Galilee to the Jordan to be baptized by John. [14] But John tried to prevent Him, saying, "I need to be baptized by You, and do You come to me?" [15] "Let it be so now," Jesus replied. "It is fitting for us to fulfill all righteousness in this way." Then John permitted Him. [16] As soon as Jesus was baptized, He went up out of the water. Suddenly the heavens were opened, and He saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove and resting on Him. [17] And a voice from heaven said, "This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased!"

4 Then Jesus was led by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil. [2] After fasting forty days and forty nights, He was hungry. [3] The tempter came to Him and said, "If You are the Son of God, tell these stones to become bread." [4] But Jesus answered, "It is written: 'Man shall not live on bread alone, but on every word that comes from the mouth of God.'" [5] Then the devil took Him to the holy city and set Him on the pinnacle of the temple. [6] "If You are the Son of God," he said, "throw Yourself down. For it is written: 'He will command His angels concerning You, and they will lift You up in their hands, so that You will not strike Your foot against a stone.'" [7] Jesus replied, "It is also written: 'Do not put the Lord your God to the test.'"
[8] Again, the devil took Him to a very high mountain and showed Him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory. [9] "All this I will give You," he said, "if You will fall down and worship me." [10] "Away from Me, Satan!" Jesus declared. "For it is written: 'Worship the Lord your God and serve Him only.'" [11] Then the devil left Him, and angels came and ministered to Him.

[12] When Jesus heard that John had been imprisoned, He withdrew to Galilee. [13] Leaving Nazareth, He went and lived in Capernaum, which is by the sea in the region of Zebulun and Naphtali, [14] to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet Isaiah: [15] "Land of Zebulun and land of Naphtali, the Way of the Sea, beyond the Jordan, Galilee of the Gentiles—"

[16] "the people living in darkness have seen a great light; on those living in the land of the shadow of death, a light has dawned." [17] From that time on Jesus began to preach, "Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is near." [18] As Jesus was walking beside the Sea of Galilee, He saw two brothers, Simon called Peter and his brother Andrew. They were casting a net into the sea, for they were fishermen. [19] "Come, follow Me," Jesus said, "and I will make you fishers of men." [20] And at once they left their nets and followed Him. [21] Going on from there, He saw two other brothers, James son of Zebedee and his brother John. They were in a boat with their father Zebedee, mending their nets. Jesus called them, [22] and immediately they left the boat and

their father and followed Him. [23] Jesus went throughout Galilee, teaching in their synagogues, preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing every disease and sickness among the people. [24] News about Him spread all over Syria, and people brought to Him all who were ill with various diseases, those suffering acute pain, the demon-possessed, those having seizures, and the paralyzed—and He healed them. [25] The large crowds that followed Him came from Galilee, the Decapolis, Jerusalem, Judea, and beyond the Jordan.

5 When Jesus saw the crowds, He went up on the mountain and sat down. His disciples came to Him, [2] and He began to teach them, saying: [3] "Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven." [4] Blessed are those who mourn, for they will be comforted. [5] Blessed are the meek, for they will inherit the earth. [6] Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they will be filled. [7] Blessed are the merciful, for they will be shown mercy. [8] Blessed are the pure in heart, for they will see God. [9] Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called sons of God. [10] Blessed are those who are persecuted because of righteousness, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. [11] Blessed are you when people insult you, persecute you, and falsely say all kinds of evil against you because of Me. [12] Rejoice and be glad, because great is your reward in heaven; for in the same way they persecuted the prophets before you.

[13] You are the salt of the earth. But if the salt loses its savor, how can it be made salty again? It is no longer good for anything, except to be thrown out and trampled by men. [14] You are the light of the world. A city on a hill cannot be hidden. [15] Neither do people light a lamp and put it under a basket. Instead, they set it on a stand, and it gives light to everyone in the house.

[16] In the same way, let your light shine before men, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven.

[17] Do not think that I have come to abolish the Law or the Prophets. I have not come to abolish them, but to fulfill them. [18] For I tell you truly, until heaven and earth pass away, not a single jot, not a stroke of a pen, will disappear from the Law until everything is accomplished. [19] So then, whoever breaks one of the least of these commandments and teaches others to do likewise will be called least in the kingdom of heaven; but whoever practices and teaches them will be called great in the kingdom of heaven. [20] For I tell you that unless your righteousness exceeds that of the scribes and Pharisees, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven.

[21] You have heard that it was said to the ancients, 'Do not murder' and 'Anyone who murders will be subject to judgment.' [22] But I tell you that anyone who is angry with his brother will be subject to judgment. Again, anyone who says to his brother, 'Raca,' will be subject to the Sanhedrin. But anyone who says, 'You fool!' will be subject to the fire of hell. [23] So if you are offering your gift at the altar and there remember that your brother has something against you, [24] leave your gift there before the altar. First go and be reconciled to your brother; then come and offer your gift. [25] Reconcile quickly with your adversary, while you are still on the way to court. Otherwise, he may hand you over to the judge, and the judge may hand you over to the officer, and you may be thrown into prison. [26] Truly I tell you, you will not get out until you have paid the last penny.

[27] You have heard that it was said, 'Do not commit adultery.' [28] But I tell you that anyone who looks at a woman to lust after her has already committed adultery with her in his heart. [29] If your right eye causes you to sin, gouge it out and throw it away. It is better for you to lose one part of your body than for your whole body to be thrown into hell. [30] And if your right hand causes you to sin, cut it off and throw it away. It is better for you to lose one part of your body than for your whole body to depart into hell. [31] It has also been said, 'Whoever divorces his wife must give her a certificate of divorce.'

[32] But I tell you that anyone who divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, brings adultery upon her. And he who marries a divorced woman commits adultery.

[33] Again, you have heard that it was said to the ancients, 'Do not break your oath, but fulfill your vows to the Lord.' [34] But I tell you not to swear at all: either by heaven, for it is God's throne; [35] or by the earth, for it is His footstool; or by Jerusalem, for it is the city of the great King. [36] Nor should you swear by your head, for you cannot make a single hair white or black. [37] Simply let your 'Yes' be 'Yes,' and your 'No,' 'No.' Anything more comes from the evil one.

[38] You have heard that it was said, 'Eye for eye and tooth for tooth.' [39] But I tell you not to resist an evil person. If someone slaps you on your right cheek, turn to him the other also; [40] if someone wants to sue you and take your tunic, let him have your cloak as well; [41] and if someone forces you to go one mile, go with him two miles. [42] Give to the one who asks you, and do not turn away from the one who wants to borrow from you.

[43] You have heard that it was said, 'Love your neighbor' and 'Hate your enemy.' [44] But I tell you, love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you, [45] that you may be sons of your Father in heaven. He causes His sun to rise on the evil and the good, and sends rain on the righteous and the unrighteous. [46] If you love those who love you, what reward will you get? Do not even tax collectors do the same? [47] And if you greet only your brothers, what are you doing more than others? Do not even Gentiles do the same? [48] Be perfect, therefore, as your heavenly Father is perfect.

6 "Be careful not to perform your righteous acts before men to be seen by them. If you do, you will have no reward from your Father in heaven." [2] So when you give to the needy, do not sound a trumpet before you, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and on the streets, to be honored by men. Truly I tell you, they already have their full reward. [3] But when you give to the needy, do not let your left hand know what your right hand is doing, [4] so that your giving may be in secret. And your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you.

[5] And when you pray, do not be like the hypocrites. For they love to pray standing in the synagogues and on the street corners to be seen by men. Truly I tell you, they already have their full reward. [6] But when you pray, go into your inner room, shut your door, and pray to your Father, who is unseen. And your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you. [7] And when you pray, do not babble on like pagans, for they think that by their many words they will be heard. [8] Do not be like them, for your Father knows what you need before you ask Him.

[9] So then, this is how you should pray: 'Our Father in heaven, hallowed be Your name.' [10] Your kingdom come, Your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.

[11] Give us this day our daily bread. [12] And forgive us our debts, as we also have forgiven our debtors. [13] And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.' [14] For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. [15] But if you do not forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive yours. [16] When you fast, do not be somber like the hypocrites, for they disfigure their faces to show men they are fasting. Truly I tell you, they already have their full reward. [17] But when you fast, anoint your head and wash your face, [18] so that your fasting will not be obvious to men, but only to your Father, who is unseen. And your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you.

[19] Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. [20] But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. [21] For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.

[22] The eye is the lamp of the body. If your eyes are good, your whole body will be full of light. [23] But if your eyes are bad, your whole body will be full of darkness. If then the light within you is darkness, how great is that darkness! [24] No one can serve two masters: Either he will hate the one and love the other, or he will be devoted to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve both God and money.

[25] Therefore I tell you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat or drink; or about your body, what you will wear. Is not life more than food, and the body more than clothes? [26] Look at the birds of the air: They do not sow or reap or gather into barns—and yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not much more valuable than they? [27] Who of you by worrying can add a single hour to his life? [28] And why do you worry about clothes? Consider how the lilies of the field grow: They do not labor or spin. [29] Yet I tell you that not even Solomon in all his glory was adorned like one of these. [30] If that is how God clothes the grass of the field, which is here today and tomorrow is thrown into the furnace, will He not much more clothe you, O you of little faith? [31] Therefore do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' [32] For the Gentiles strive after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them. [33] But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added unto you. [34] Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own.

7 "Do not judge, or you will be judged." [2] For with the same judgment you pronounce, you will be judged; and with the measure you use, it will be measured to you. [3] Why do you look at the speck in your brother's eye, but fail to notice the beam in your own eye? [4] How can you say to your brother, 'Let me take the speck out of your eye,' while there is still a beam in your own eye? [5] You hypocrite! First take the beam out of your own eye, and then you will see clearly to remove the speck from your brother's eye. [6] Do not give dogs what is holy; do not throw your pearls before swine. If you do, they may trample them under their feet, and then turn and tear you to pieces. [7] Ask, and it will be given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and the door will be opened to you. [8] For everyone who asks receives; he who seeks finds; and to him who knocks, the door will be opened.

[9] Which of you, if his son asks for bread, will give him a stone? [10] Or if he asks for a fish, will give him a snake? [11] So if you who are evil know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good things to those who ask Him!

[12] In everything, then, do to others as you would have them do to you. For this is the essence of the Law and the Prophets. [13] Enter through the narrow gate. For wide is the gate and broad is the way that leads to destruction, and many enter through it. [14] But small is the gate and narrow the way that leads to life, and only a few find it. [15] Beware of false prophets. They come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly they are ravenous wolves. [16] By their fruit you will recognize them. Are grapes gathered from thornbushes, or figs from thistles? [17] Likewise, every good tree bears good fruit, but a bad tree bears bad fruit. [18] A good tree cannot bear bad fruit, and a bad tree cannot bear good fruit.

[19] Every tree that does not bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire. [20] So then, by their fruit you will recognize them. [21] Not everyone who says to Me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter the kingdom of heaven, but only he who does the will of My Father in heaven. [22] Many will say to Me on that day, 'Lord, Lord, did we not prophesy in Your name, and in Your name drive out demons and perform many miracles?' [23] Then I will tell them plainly, 'I never knew you; depart from Me, you workers of lawlessness!' [24] Therefore everyone who hears these words of Mine and acts on them is like a wise man who built his house on the rock. [25] The rain fell, the torrents raged, and the winds blew and beat against that house; yet it did not fall, because its foundation was on the rock. [26] But everyone who hears these words of Mine and does not act on them is like a foolish man who built his house on sand. [27] "The rain fell, the torrents raged, and the winds blew and beat against that house, and it fell—and great was its collapse!" [28] When Jesus had finished saying these things, the crowds were astonished at His teaching, [29] because He taught as one who had authority, and not as their scribes.

8 When Jesus came down from the mountain, large crowds followed Him. [2] Suddenly a leper came and knelt before Him, saying, "Lord, if You are willing, You can make me clean." [3] Jesus reached out His hand and touched the man. "I am willing," He said. "Be clean!" And immediately his leprosy was cleansed. [4] Then Jesus instructed him, "See that you don't tell anyone. But go, show yourself to the priest and offer the gift prescribed by Moses, as a testimony to them." [5] When Jesus had entered Capernaum, a centurion came and pleaded with Him, [6] "Lord, my servant lies at home, paralyzed and in terrible agony." [7] "I will go and heal him," Jesus replied. [8] The centurion answered, "Lord, I am not worthy to have You come under my roof. But just say the word, and my servant will be healed." [9] "For I myself am a man under authority, with soldiers under me. I tell one to go, and he goes; and another to come, and he comes. I tell my servant to do something, and he does it." [10] When Jesus heard this, He marveled and said to those following Him, "Truly I tell you, I have not found anyone in Israel with such great faith."

[11] I say to you that many will come from the east and the west to share the banquet with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven. [12] "But the sons of the kingdom will be thrown into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth." [13] Then Jesus said to the centurion, "Go! As you have believed, so will it be done for you." And his servant was healed at that very hour. [14] When Jesus arrived at Peter's house, He saw Peter's mother-in-law sick in bed with a fever.

[15] So He touched her hand, and the fever left her, and she got up and began to serve Him. [16] When evening came, many who were demon-possessed were brought to Jesus, and He drove out the spirits with a word and healed all the sick. [17] This was to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet Isaiah: "He took on our infirmities and carried our diseases." [18] When Jesus saw a large crowd around Him, He gave orders to cross to the other side of the sea. [19] And one of the scribes came to Him and said, "Teacher, I will follow You wherever You go." [20] Jesus replied, "Foxes have dens and birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has no place to lay His head." [21] Another of His disciples requested, "Lord, first let me go and bury my father."

[22] But Jesus told him, "Follow Me, and let the dead bury their own dead." [23] When He got into the boat, His disciples followed Him. [24] Suddenly a violent storm came up on the sea, so that the boat was engulfed by the waves; but Jesus was sleeping. [25] The disciples went and woke Him, saying, "Lord, save us! We are perishing!" [26] "You of little faith," Jesus replied, "why are you so afraid?" Then He got up and rebuked the winds and the sea, and it was perfectly calm. [27] The men were amazed and asked, "What kind of man is this? Even the winds and the sea obey Him!" [28] When Jesus arrived on the other side in the region of the Gadarenes, He was met by two demon-possessed men coming from the tombs. They were so violent that no one could pass that way. [29] "What do You want with us, Son of God?" they shouted. "Have You come here to torture us before the appointed time?" [30] In the distance a large herd of pigs was feeding. [31] So the demons begged Jesus, "If You drive us out, send us into the herd of pigs." [32] "Go!" He told them. So they came out and went into the pigs, and the whole herd rushed down the steep bank into the sea and died in the waters. [33] Those tending the pigs ran off into the town and reported all this, including the account of the demon-possessed men. [34] Then the whole town went out to meet Jesus. And when they saw Him, they begged Him to leave their region.

9 Jesus got into a boat, crossed over, and came to His own town. [2] Just then some men brought to Him a paralytic lying on a mat. When Jesus saw their faith, He said to the paralytic, "Take courage, son; your sins are forgiven." [3] On seeing this, some of the scribes said to themselves, "This man is blaspheming!" [4] But Jesus knew what they were thinking and said, "Why do you harbor evil in your hearts?" [5] Which is easier: to say, 'Your sins are forgiven,' or to say, 'Get up and walk?' [6] "But so that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins..." Then He said to the paralytic, "Get up, pick up your mat, and go home." [7] And the man got up and went home. [8] When the crowds saw this, they were filled with awe and glorified God, who had given such authority to men. [9] As Jesus went on from there, He saw a man named Matthew sitting at the tax booth. "Follow Me," He told him, and Matthew got up and followed Him. [10] Later, as Jesus was dining at Matthew's house, many tax collectors and sinners came and ate with Him and His disciples.

[11] When the Pharisees saw this, they asked His disciples, "Why does your Teacher eat with tax collectors and sinners?"

[12] On hearing this, Jesus said, "It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick." [13] "But go and learn what this means: 'I desire mercy, not sacrifice.' For I have not come to call the righteous, but sinners." [14] At that time John's disciples came to Jesus and asked, "Why is it that we and the Pharisees fast so often, but Your disciples do not fast?" [15] Jesus replied, "How can the guests of the bridegroom mourn while He is with them? But the time will come when the bridegroom will be taken from them; then they will fast." [16] No one sews a patch of unshrunk cloth on an old garment. For the patch will pull away from the garment, and a worse tear will result. [17] "Neither do men pour new wine into old wineskins. If they do, the skins will burst, the wine will spill, and the wineskins will be ruined. Instead, they pour new wine into new wineskins, and both are preserved." [18] While Jesus was saying these things, a synagogue leader came and knelt before Him. "My daughter has just died," he said. "But come and place Your hand on her, and she will live." [19] So Jesus got up and went with him, along with His disciples. [20] Suddenly a woman who had suffered from bleeding for twelve years came up behind Him and touched the fringe of His cloak. [21] She said to herself, "If only I touch His cloak, I will be healed." [22] Jesus turned and saw her. "Take courage, daughter," He said, "your faith has healed you." And the woman was cured from that very hour. [23] When Jesus entered the house of the synagogue leader, He saw the flute players and the noisy crowd. [24] "Go away," He told them. "The girl is not dead, but asleep." And they laughed at Him.

[25] After the crowd had been put outside, Jesus went in and took the girl by the hand, and she got up. [26] And the news about this spread throughout that region. [27] As Jesus went on from there, two blind men followed Him, crying out, "Have mercy on us, Son of David!" [28] After Jesus had entered the house, the blind men came to Him. "Do you believe that I am able to do this?" He asked. "Yes, Lord," they answered.

[29] Then He touched their eyes and said, "According to your faith will it be done to you." [30] And their eyes were opened. Jesus warned them sternly, "See that no one finds out about this!" [31] But they went out and spread the news about Him throughout the land. [32] As they were leaving, a demon-possessed man who was mute was brought to Jesus. [33] And when the demon had been driven out, the man began to speak. The crowds were amazed and said, "Nothing like this has ever been seen in Israel!" [34] But the Pharisees said, "It is by the prince of demons that He drives out demons." [35] Jesus went through all the towns and villages, teaching in their synagogues, preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing every disease and sickness. [36] When He saw the crowds, He was moved with compassion for them, because they were harassed and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd. [37] Then He said to His disciples, "The harvest is plentiful, but the workers are few." [38] "Ask the Lord of the harvest, therefore, to send out workers into His harvest."

10 And calling His twelve disciples to Him, Jesus gave them authority over unclean spirits, so that they could drive them out and heal every disease and sickness. [2] These are the names of the twelve apostles: first Simon, called Peter, and his brother Andrew; James son of Zebedee, and his brother John; [3] Philip and Bartholomew; Thomas and Matthew the tax collector; James son of Alphaeus, and Thaddaeus; [4] Simon the Zealot, and Judas Iscariot, who betrayed Jesus. [5] These twelve Jesus sent out with the following instructions: "Do not go onto the road of the Gentiles or enter any town of the Samaritans." [6] Go rather to the lost sheep of Israel. [7] As you go, preach this message: 'The kingdom of heaven is near.' [8] Heal the sick, raise the dead, cleanse the lepers, drive out demons. Freely you have received; freely give. [9] Do not carry any gold or silver or copper in your belts. [10] Take no bag for the road, or second tunic, or sandals, or staff; for the worker is worthy of his provisions. [11] Whatever town or village you enter, find out who is worthy there and stay at his house until you move on. [12] As you enter the home, greet its occupants. [13] If the home is worthy, let your peace rest on it; but if it is not, let your peace return to you.

[14] And if anyone will not welcome you or heed your words, shake the dust off your feet when you leave that home or town. [15] Truly I tell you, it will be more bearable for Sodom and Gomorrah on the day of judgment than for that town. [16] Behold, I am sending you out like sheep among wolves; therefore be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves. [17] But beware of men; for they will hand you over to their councils and flog you in their synagogues. [18] On My account, you will be brought before governors and kings as witnesses to them and to the Gentiles. [19] But when they hand you over, do not worry about how to respond or what to say. In that hour you will be given what to say. [20] For it will not be you speaking, but the Spirit of your Father speaking through you. [21] Brother will betray brother to death, and a father his child; children will rise against their parents and have them put to death. [22] You will be hated by everyone because of My name, but the one who perseveres to the end will be saved. [23] When they persecute you in one town, flee to the next. Truly I tell you, you will not reach all the towns of Israel before the Son of Man comes. [24] A disciple is not above his teacher, nor a servant above his master. [25] It is enough for a disciple to be like his teacher, and a servant like his master. If the head of the house has been called Beelzebul, how much more the members of his household!

[26] So do not be afraid of them. For there is nothing concealed that will not be disclosed, and nothing hidden that will not be made known. [27] What I tell you in the dark, speak in the daylight; what is whispered in your ear, proclaim from the housetops.

[28] Do not be afraid of those who kill the body but cannot kill the soul. Instead, fear the One who can destroy both soul and body in hell. [29] Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground apart from the will of your Father. [30] And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. [31] So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows. [32] Therefore everyone who confesses Me before men, I will also confess him before My Father in heaven. [33] But whoever denies Me before men, I will also deny him before My Father in heaven. [34] Do not assume that I have come to bring peace to the earth; I have not come to bring peace, but a sword. [35] For I have come to turn 'a man against his father, a daughter against her mother, a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law.' [36] A man's enemies will be the members of his own household.' [37] Anyone who loves his father or mother more than Me is not worthy of Me; anyone who loves his son or daughter more than Me is not worthy of Me; [38] and anyone who does not take up his cross and follow Me is not worthy of Me. [39] Whoever finds his life will lose it, and whoever loses his life for My sake will find it. [40] He who receives you receives Me, and he who receives Me receives the One who sent Me. [41] Whoever receives a prophet because he is a prophet will receive a prophet's reward, and whoever receives a righteous man because he is a righteous man will receive a righteous man's reward. [42] "And if anyone gives even a cup of cold water to one of these little ones because he is My disciple, truly I tell you, he will never lose his reward."

11 After Jesus had finished instructing His twelve disciples, He went on from there to teach and preach in their cities. [2] Meanwhile John heard in prison about the works of Christ, and he sent his disciples [3] to ask Him, "Are You the One who was to come, or should we look for someone else?" [4] Jesus replied, "Go back and report to John what you hear and see:" [5] The blind receive sight, the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, and the good news is preached to the poor. [6] "Blessed is the one who does not fall away on account of Me." [7] As John's disciples were leaving, Jesus began to speak to the crowds about John: "What did you go out into the wilderness to see? A reed swaying in the wind?" [8] Otherwise, what did you go out to see? A man dressed in fine clothes? Look, those who wear fine clothing are found in kings' palaces. [9] What then did you go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I tell you, and more than a prophet.

[10] This is the one about whom it is written: 'Behold, I will send My messenger ahead of You, who will prepare Your way before You.' [11] Truly I tell you, among those born of women there has risen no one greater than John the Baptist. Yet even the least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he. [12] From the days of John the Baptist until now, the kingdom of heaven has been subject to violence, and the violent lay claim to it. [13] For all the Prophets and the Law prophesied until John. [14] And if you are willing to accept it, he is the Elijah who was to come. [15] He who has ears, let him hear. [16] To what can I compare this generation? They are like children sitting in the marketplaces and calling out to others: [17] 'We played the flute for you, and you did not dance; we sang a dirge, and you did not mourn.' [18] For John came neither eating nor drinking, and they say, 'He has a demon!' [19] "The Son of Man came eating and drinking, and they say, 'Look at this glutton and drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!' But wisdom is vindicated by her actions."

[20] Then Jesus began to denounce the cities in which most of His miracles had been performed, because they did not repent. [21] "Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you, Bethsaida! For if the miracles that were performed in you had been performed in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes." [22] But I tell you, it will be more bearable for Tyre and Sidon on the day of judgment than for you. [23] And you, Capernaum, will you be lifted up to heaven? No, you will be brought down to Hades! For if the miracles that were performed in you had been performed in Sodom, it would have remained to this day. [24] "But I tell you that it will be more bearable for Sodom on the day of judgment than for you." [25] At that time Jesus declared, "I praise You, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because You have hidden these things from the wise and learned, and revealed them to little children." [26] Yes, Father, for this was well-pleasing in Your sight. [27] All things have been entrusted to Me by My Father. No one knows the Son except the Father, and no one knows the Father except the Son and those to whom the Son chooses to reveal Him. [28] Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. [29] Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. [30] "For My yoke is easy and My burden is light."

12 At that time Jesus went through the grainfields on the Sabbath. His disciples were hungry and began to pick the heads of grain and eat them. [2] When the Pharisees saw this, they said to Him, "Look, Your disciples are doing what is unlawful on the Sabbath." [3] Jesus replied, "Have you not read what David did when he and his companions were hungry?" [4] He entered the house of God, and he and his companions ate the consecrated bread, which was not lawful for them to eat, but only for the priests. [5] Or haven't you read in the Law that on the Sabbath the priests in the temple break the Sabbath and yet are innocent? [6] But I tell you that something greater than the temple is here. [7] If only you had known the meaning of 'I desire mercy, not sacrifice,' you would not have condemned the innocent. [8] "For the Son of Man is Lord of the Sabbath." [9] Moving on from there, Jesus entered their synagogue, [10] and a man with a withered hand was there. In order to accuse Jesus, they asked Him, "Is it lawful to heal on the Sabbath?" [11] He replied, "If one of you has a sheep and it falls into a pit on the Sabbath, will he not take hold of it and lift it out?" [12] "How much more valuable is a man than a sheep! Therefore it is lawful to do good on the Sabbath." [13] Then Jesus said to the man, "Stretch out your hand." So he stretched it out, and it was restored to full use, just like the other. [14] But the Pharisees went out and plotted how they might kill Jesus. [15] Aware of this, Jesus withdrew from that place. Large crowds followed Him, and He healed them all, [16] warning them not to make Him known. [17] This was to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet Isaiah: [18] "Here is My Servant, whom I have chosen, My beloved, in whom My soul delights. I will put My Spirit on Him, and He will proclaim justice to the nations." [19] He will not quarrel or cry out; no one will hear His voice in the streets. [20] A bruised reed He will not break, and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish, till He leads justice to victory. [21] "In His name the nations will put their hope."

[22] Then a demon-possessed man who was blind and mute was brought to Jesus, and He healed the man so that he could speak and see. [23] The crowds were astounded and asked, "Could this be the Son of David?" [24] But when the Pharisees heard this, they said, "Only by Beelzebul, the prince of demons, does this man drive out demons." [25] Knowing their thoughts, Jesus said to them, "Every kingdom divided against itself will be laid waste, and every city or household divided against itself will not stand." [26] If Satan drives out Satan, he is divided against himself. How then can his kingdom stand? [27] And if I drive out demons by Beelzebul, by whom do your sons drive them out? So then, they will be your judges. [28] But if I drive out demons by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God has come upon you. [29] Or again, how can anyone enter a strong man's house and steal his possessions, unless he first ties up the strong man? Then he can plunder his house. [30] He who is not with Me is against Me, and he who does not gather with Me scatters. [31] Therefore I tell you, every sin and blasphemy will be forgiven men, but the blasphemy against the Spirit will not be forgiven. [32] Whoever speaks a word against the Son of Man will be forgiven, but whoever speaks against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven, either in this age or in the one to come.

[33] Make a tree good and its fruit will be good, or make a tree bad and its fruit will be bad; for a tree is known by its fruit. [34] You brood of vipers, how can you who are evil say anything good? For out of the overflow of the heart, the mouth speaks. [35] The good man brings good things out of his good store of treasure, and the evil man brings evil things out of his evil store of treasure. [36] But I tell you that men will give an account on the day of judgment for every careless word they have spoken. [37] "For by your words you will be acquitted, and by your words you will be condemned." [38] Then some of the scribes and Pharisees said to Him, "Teacher, we want to see a sign from You." [39] Jesus replied, "A wicked and adulterous generation demands a sign, but none will be given it except the sign of the prophet Jonah." [40] For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of the great fish, so the Son of Man will be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth. [41] The men of Nineveh will stand at the judgment with this generation and condemn it; for they repented at the preaching of Jonah, and now One greater than Jonah is here. [42] The Queen of the South will rise at the judgment with this generation and condemn it; for she came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon, and now One greater than Solomon is here. [43] When an unclean spirit comes out of a man, it passes through arid places seeking rest and does not find it. [44] Then it says, 'I will return to the house I left.' On its return, it finds the house vacant, swept clean, and put in order. [45] "Then it goes and brings with it seven other spirits more wicked than itself, and they go in and dwell there; and the final plight of that man is worse than the first. So will it be with this wicked generation." [46] While Jesus was still speaking to the crowds, His mother and brothers stood outside, wanting to speak to Him. [47] Someone told Him, "Look, Your mother and brothers are standing outside, wanting to speak to You." [48] But Jesus replied, "Who is My mother, and who are My brothers?" [49] Pointing to His disciples, He said, "Here are My mother and My brothers." [50] "For whoever does the will of My Father in heaven is My brother and sister and mother."

13 That same day Jesus went out of the house and sat by the sea. [2] Such large crowds gathered around Him that He got into a boat and sat down, while all the people stood on the shore. [3] And He told them many things in parables, saying, "A farmer went out to sow his seed." [4] And as he was sowing, some seed fell along the path, and the birds came and devoured it. [5] Some fell on rocky ground, where it did not have much soil. It sprang up quickly because the soil was shallow. [6] But when the sun rose, the seedlings were scorched, and they withered because they had no root. [7] Other seed fell among thorns, which grew up and choked the seedlings. [8] Still other seed fell on good soil and produced a crop—a hundredfold, sixtyfold, or thirtyfold. [9] "He who has ears, let him hear." [10] Then the disciples came to Jesus and asked, "Why do You speak to the people in parables?" [11] He replied, "The

knowledge of the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven has been given to you, but not to them." [12] Whoever has will be given more, and he will have an abundance. Whoever does not have, even what he has will be taken away from him. [13] This is why I speak to them in parables: 'Though seeing, they do not see; though hearing, they do not hear or understand.' [14] In them the prophecy of Isaiah is fulfilled: 'You will be ever hearing but never understanding; you will be ever seeing but never perceiving.' [15] For this people's heart has grown callous; they hardly hear with their ears, and they have closed their eyes. Otherwise they might see with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their hearts, and turn, and I would heal them.' [16] But blessed are your eyes because they see, and your ears because they hear. [17] For truly I tell you, many prophets and righteous men longed to see what you see but did not see it, and to hear what you hear but did not hear it. [18] Consider, then, the parable of the sower: [19] When anyone hears the message of the kingdom but does not understand it, the evil one comes and snatches away what was sown in his heart. This is the seed sown along the path. [20] The seed sown on rocky ground is the one who hears the word and at once receives it with joy. [21] But since he has no root, he remains for only a season. When trouble or persecution comes because of the word, he quickly falls away. [22] The seed sown among the thorns is the one who hears the word, but the worries of this life and the deceitfulness of wealth choke the word, and it becomes unfruitful. [23] "But the seed sown on good soil is the one who hears the word and understands it. He indeed bears fruit and produces a crop—a hundredfold, sixtyfold, or thirtyfold." [24] Jesus put before them another parable: "The kingdom of heaven is like a man who sowed good seed in his field." [25] But while everyone was asleep, his enemy came and sowed weeds among the wheat, and slipped away. [26] When the wheat sprouted and bore grain, then the weeds also appeared. [27] The owner's servants came to him and said, 'Sir, didn't you sow good seed in your field? Where then did the weeds come from?' [28] 'An enemy did this,' he replied. So the servants asked him, 'Do you want us to go and pull them up?' [29] 'No,' he said, 'if you pull the weeds now, you might uproot the wheat with them.' [30] "Let both grow together until the harvest. At that time I will tell the harvesters: First collect the weeds and tie them in bundles to be burned; then gather the wheat into my barn.'" [31] He put before them another parable: "The kingdom of heaven is like a mustard seed that a man planted in his field." [32] "Although it is the smallest of all seeds, yet it grows into the largest of garden plants and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the air come and nest in its branches." [33] He told them still another parable: "The kingdom of heaven is like leaven that a woman took and mixed into three measures of flour, until all of it was leavened." [34] Jesus spoke all these things to the crowds in parables. He did not tell them anything without using a parable. [35] So was fulfilled what was spoken through the prophet: "I will open My mouth in parables; I will utter things hidden since the foundation of the world."

[36] Then Jesus dismissed the crowds and went into the house. His disciples came to Him and said, "Explain to us the parable of the weeds in the field." [37] He replied, "The One who sows the good seed is the Son of Man."

[38] The field is the world, and the good seed represents the sons of the kingdom. The weeds are the sons of the evil one, [39] and the enemy who sows them is the devil. The harvest is the end of the age, and the harvesters are angels. [40] As the weeds are collected and burned in the fire, so will it be at the end of the age. [41] The Son of Man will send out His angels, and they will weed out of His kingdom every cause of sin and all who practice lawlessness. [42] And they will throw them into the fiery furnace, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth. [43] Then the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. He who has ears, let him hear. [44] The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field. When a man found it, he hid it again, and in his joy he went and sold all he had and bought that field. [45] Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant in search of fine pearls. [46] When he found one very precious pearl, he went away and sold all he had and bought it. [47] Once again, the kingdom of heaven is like a net that was cast into the sea and caught all kinds of fish. [48] When it was full, the men pulled it ashore. Then they sat down and sorted the good fish into containers, but threw the bad away. [49] So will it be at the end of the age: The angels will come and separate the wicked from the righteous, [50] and throw them into the fiery furnace, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth. [51] "Have you understood all these things?" "Yes," they answered. [52] Then He told them, "For this reason, every scribe who has been discipled in the kingdom of heaven is like a homeowner who brings out of his storeroom new treasures as well as old." [53] When Jesus had finished these parables, He withdrew from that place. [54] Coming to His hometown, He taught the people in their synagogue, and they were astonished. "Where did this man get such wisdom and miraculous powers?" they asked. [55] "Isn't this the carpenter's son? Isn't His mother's name Mary, and aren't His brothers James, Joseph, Simon, and Judas?" [56] "Aren't all His sisters with us as well? Where then did this man get all these things?" [57] And they took offense at Him. But Jesus said to them, "Only in his hometown and in his own household is a prophet without honor." [58] And He did not do many miracles there, because of their unbelief.

14 At that time Herod the tetrarch heard the reports about Jesus [2] and said to his servants, "This is John the Baptist; he has risen from the dead! That is why miraculous powers are at work in him." [3] Now Herod had arrested John and bound him and put him in prison on account of Herodias, his brother Philip's wife, [4] because John had been telling him, "It is not lawful for you to have her." [5] Although Herod wanted to kill John, he was afraid of the people, because they regarded John as a prophet. [6] On Herod's birthday, however, the daughter of Herodias danced before them and pleased Herod [7] so much that he promised with an oath to give to her whatever she asked. [8] Prompted by her mother, she said, "Give me here on a platter the head of John the Baptist." [9] The king was grieved, but because of his oaths and his guests, he ordered that her wish be granted [10] and sent to have John beheaded in the prison. [11] John's head was brought in on a platter and presented to the girl, who carried it to her mother.

[12] Then John's disciples came and took his body and buried it. And they went and informed Jesus. [13] When Jesus heard about John, He withdrew by boat privately to a solitary place. But the crowds found out about it and followed Him on foot from the towns. [14] When He stepped ashore and saw a large crowd, He had compassion on them and healed their sick. [15] When evening came, the disciples came to Him and said, "This is a desolate place, and the hour is already late. Dismiss the crowds so they can go to the villages and buy themselves some food." [16] "They do not need to go away," Jesus replied. "You give them something to eat." [17] "We have here only five loaves of bread and two fish," they answered. [18] "Bring them here to Me," Jesus said. [19] And He directed the crowds to sit down on the grass. Taking the five loaves and the two fish and looking up to heaven, He spoke a blessing. Then He broke the loaves and gave them to the disciples, and the disciples gave them to the people. [20] They all ate and were satisfied, and the disciples picked up twelve basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over. [21] About five thousand men were fed, in addition to women and children. [22] Immediately Jesus made the disciples get into the boat and go on ahead of Him to the other side, while He dismissed the crowds. [23] After He had sent them away, He went up on the mountain by Himself to pray. When evening came, He was there alone, [24] but the boat was already far from land, buffeted by the waves because the wind was against it. [25] During the fourth watch of the night, Jesus went out to them, walking on the sea. [26] When the disciples saw Him walking on the sea, they were terrified. "It's a ghost!" they said, and cried out in fear. [27] But Jesus spoke up at once: "Take courage! It is I. Do not be afraid."

[28] "Lord, if it is You," Peter replied, "command me to come to You on the water." [29] "Come," said Jesus. Then Peter got down out of the boat, walked on the water, and came toward Jesus. [30] But when he saw the strength of the wind, he was afraid, and beginning to sink, cried out, "Lord, save me!" [31] Immediately Jesus reached out His hand and took hold of Peter. "You of little faith," He said, "why did you doubt?" [32] And when they had climbed back into the boat, the wind died down. [33] Then those who were in the boat worshiped Him, saying, "Truly You are the Son of God!" [34] When they had crossed over, they landed at Gennesaret. [35] And when the men of that place recognized Jesus, they sent word to all the surrounding region. People brought all the sick to Him [36] and begged Him just to let them touch the fringe of His cloak. And all who touched Him were healed.

15 Then some Pharisees and scribes came to Jesus from Jerusalem and asked, [2] "Why do Your disciples break the tradition of the elders? They do not wash their hands before they eat." [3] Jesus replied, "And why do you break the command of God for the sake of your tradition?" [4] For God said, 'Honor your father and mother' and 'Anyone who curses his father or mother must be put to death.' [5] But you say that if anyone says to his father or mother, 'Whatever you would have received from me is a gift devoted to God,' [6] he need not honor his father or mother with it. Thus you nullify the word of God for the sake of your tradition. [7] You hypocrites! Isaiah prophesied correctly about you: [8] 'These people honor Me with their lips, but their hearts are far from Me.' [9] "They worship Me in vain; they teach as doctrine the precepts of men.'" [10] Jesus called the crowd to Him and said, "Listen and understand." [11] "A man is not defiled by what enters his mouth, but by what comes out of it." [12] Then the disciples came to Him and said, "Are You aware that the Pharisees were offended when they heard this?"

[13] But Jesus replied, "Every plant that My heavenly Father has not planted will be pulled up by its roots." [14] "Disregard them! They are blind guides. If a blind man leads a blind man, both will fall into a pit." [15] Peter said to Him, "Explain this parable to us." [16] "Do you still not understand?" Jesus asked. [17] "Do you not yet realize that whatever enters the mouth goes into the stomach and then is eliminated?" [18] But the things that come out of the mouth come from the heart, and these things defile a man. [19] For out of the heart come evil thoughts, murder, adultery, sexual immorality, theft, false testimony, and slander. [20] "These are what defile a man, but eating with unwashed hands does not defile him." [21] Leaving that place, Jesus withdrew to the district of Tyre and Sidon. [22] And a Canaanite woman from that region came to Him, crying out, "Lord, Son of David, have mercy on me! My daughter is miserably possessed by a demon." [23] But Jesus did not answer a word. So His disciples came and urged Him, "Send her away, for she keeps crying out after us." [24] He answered, "I was sent only to the lost sheep of the house of Israel."

[25] The woman came and knelt before Him. "Lord, help me!" she said.

[26] But Jesus replied, "It is not right to take the children's bread and toss it to the dogs." [27] "Yes, Lord," she said, "even the dogs eat the crumbs that fall from their master's table." [28] "O woman," Jesus answered, "your faith is great! Let it be done

for you as you desire." And her daughter was healed from that very hour. [29] Moving on from there, Jesus went along the Sea of Galilee. Then He went up on a mountain and sat down. [30] Large crowds came to Him, bringing the lame, the blind, the crippled, the mute, and many others, and laid them at His feet, and He healed them. [31] The crowd was amazed when they saw the mute speaking, the crippled restored, the lame walking, and the blind seeing. And they glorified the God of Israel. [32] Then Jesus called His disciples to Him and said, "I have compassion for this crowd, because they have already been with Me three days and have nothing to eat. I do not want to send them away hungry, or they may faint along the way." [33] The disciples replied, "Where in this desolate place could we find enough bread to feed such a large crowd?" [34] "How many loaves do you have?" Jesus asked. "Seven," they replied, "and a few small fish." [35] And He instructed the crowd to sit down on the ground. [36] Taking the seven loaves and the fish, He gave thanks and broke them. Then He gave them to the disciples, and the disciples gave them to the people. [37] They all ate and were satisfied, and the disciples picked up seven basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over. [38] A total of four thousand men were fed, in addition to women and children. [39] After Jesus had dismissed the crowds, He got into the boat and went to the region of Magadan.

16 Then the Pharisees and Sadducees came and tested Jesus by asking Him to show them a sign from heaven. [2] But He replied, "When evening comes, you say, 'The weather will be fair, for the sky is red,'" [3] and in the morning, 'Today it will be stormy, for the sky is red and overcast.' You know how to interpret the appearance of the sky, but not the signs of the times. [4] "A wicked and adulterous generation demands a sign, but none will be given it except the sign of Jonah." Then He left them and went away. [5] When they crossed to the other side, the disciples forgot to take bread. [6] "Watch out!" Jesus told them. "Beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and Sadducees." [7] They discussed this among themselves and concluded, "It is because we did not bring any bread."